Q. Who is India's No. 1 male cricketer?



2 **M.S. DHONI** 13.4 [20.9]



3 **HARDIK PANDYA** 9.1 [0.7]



4 **ROHIT SHARMA** 9.1 [11.2]



5 **SURYAKUMAR YADAV** 5.2 [0.9]





PTI

Q. Who is India's No. 1 female cricketer?

1 **SMRITI MANDHANA** 36.6 [53.4]



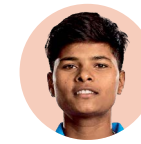
2 **SHAFALI VERMA** 16.3 [4.1]



3 **HARMANPREET KAUR** 11.1 [10.1]



4 **DEEPTI SHARMA** 6.2 [6.2]



5 **KRANTI GOUD** 4 [NA]

Rest, others & don't know/ can't say; all figures in %; Jan. '26 figures in red, Aug. '25 in []

Shafali Verma, whose match-defining contributions in the World Cup final with both bat and ball propel her to No. 2. Kaur finishes third, followed by player-of-the-tournament Deepti Sharma. They are joined in the 'Super Seven' by pacer Kranti Goud, wicket-keeper Richa Ghosh and the stylish batter Jemimah Rodrigues.

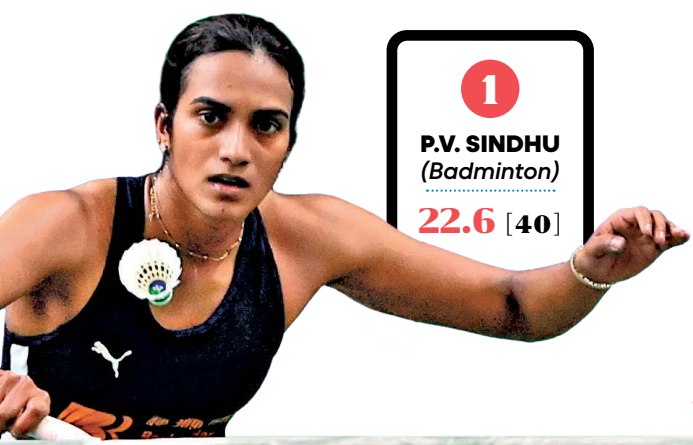
Looking beyond the cricket field, two-time Olympic medallist Neeraj Chopra, in what amounts to a mid-dling year by his exalted standards, retains pole position. Grandmaster D. Gukesh—the reigning world chess champion in the classical format—also sees his popularity climb despite a testing 2025.

Even as Indian football contin-ues to drift, with the Indian Super League deferred to February, MOTN respondents rally behind the national side's all-time leading scorer, Sunil Chhetri. In hockey, former skip-per Manpreet Singh emerges as the biggest gainer, closely trailed by the incumbent, Harmanpreet Singh.

Predictably, among women sportspersons, Olympic medallists P.V. Sindhu (badminton), Manu Bhaker (shooting), Mirabai Chanu (weightlifting) and Lovlina Borgohain (boxing) claim the top spots. The most striking inclusion, however, is that of Paralympian archer and newly crowned world champion Sheetal Devi. At 19, the armless athlete stands as a reminder that sporting excel-lence in India is no longer confined to conventional notions of ability. ■



PTI



1 **P.V. SINDHU** *(Badminton)* 22.6 [40]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 female sportsperson?



2 **MANU BHAKER** *(Shooting)* 16.5 [2.3]



3 **MIRABAI CHANU** *(Weightlifting)* 11.6 [4.8]



4 **LOVLINA BORGOHAIN** *(Boxing)* 4.6 [1.8]



5 **SHEETAL DEVI** *(Archery)* 4.4 [NA]



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